

Optional Lab(Optional B: JavaScript): Querying with GraphQL



Estimated Time: 60 minutes

In this lab, you will become familiar with using GraphQL to query the APIs served through a GraphQL service running on a server using Postman.

Learning objectives:

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Use GraphQL with Postman to access GraphQL Service
- Structure queries to access APIs to get selective information that you need

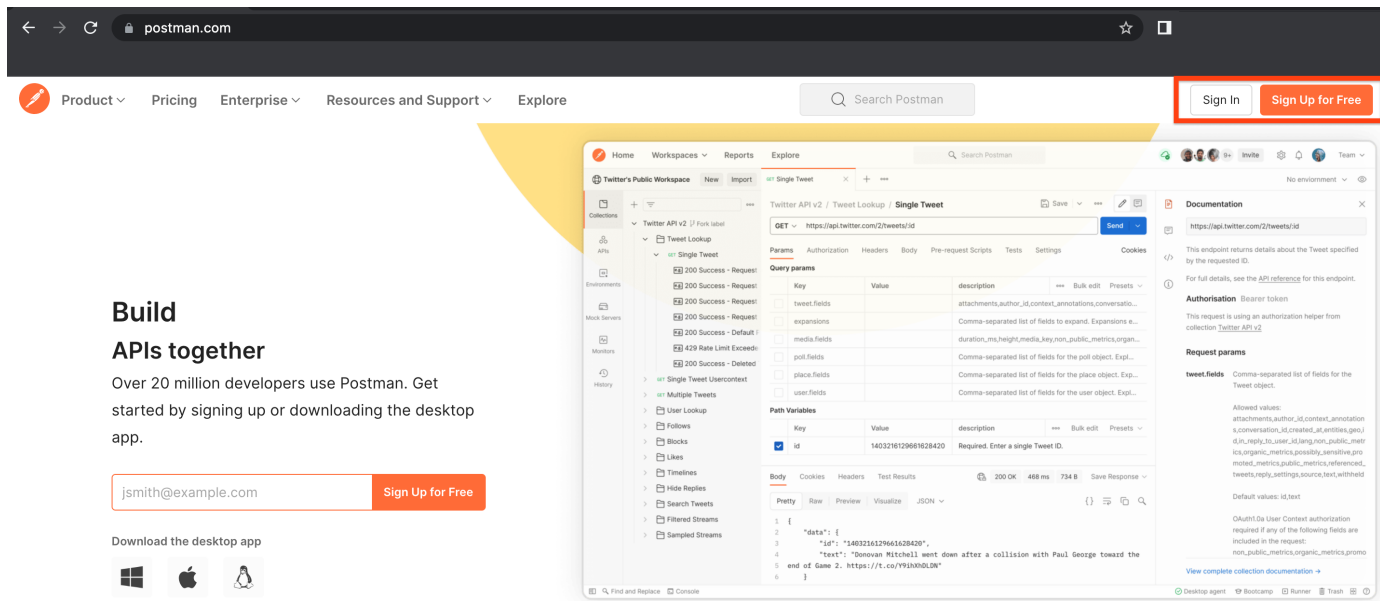
Prerequisites

- You must be familiar with Docker applications and commands.
- You must have a good understanding of API.
- You must be familiar with using Postman.

Task 1 - Sign-up for Postman

If you already have a Postman account, you can skip this task.

1. On your browser, go to www.postman.com.



2. Click **Sign Up for Free**.

3. Enter your email and choose a password, confirm it, and create a free account. You can alternatively use your Google account to sign in too. You may notice that **Stay signed in for 30 days** is selected by default. It is highly recommended that you uncheck that option if you are not using a personal computer for this lab.



Why sign up?

- Organize all your API development within Postman Workspaces
- Sync your Postman data across devices
- Backup your data to the Postman cloud
- It's free!



Create Postman Account [Sign In instead?](#)

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Username

Password

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☐ Sign up to get product updates, news, and other marketing communications.

☒ Stay signed in for 30 days

By creating an account, I agree to the [Terms](#) and [Privacy Policy](#).

Create free account

or



Sign up with Google

Sign in with SSO

You have successfully created a Postman account.

Task 2 - Run a GraphQL service

1. Open a terminal window by using the top menu in the IDE: **Terminal** > **New Terminal**.

2. In the terminal, clone the repository that has the GraphQL service code ready by pasting the following command. The repository that you clone has code that will run a GraphQL service where we can query details on US cities and states.

```
git clone https://github.com/iam-developer/skills-network/shug-csai-microservices_1s.git
```

3. Change the working directory to **jungdo-microservices/graphql_example** by running the following command.

```
cd shug-csai-microservices_1s/graphql_example
```

4. Build the application by running the following command. This will build the docker application using the docker file in the current directory and tag it **graphqlservice**.

```
docker build -t graphqlservice
```

5. Run the application that you just built on port 8080, by running the following command on the terminal.

```
docker run -p 8080:8080 graphqlservice
```

You will get a hex code that indicates the application has started.

6. To confirm that the service is running, execute the following command.

```
curl localhost:8080
```

```
theia@theiadocker-3-labs-prod-theiak8s-4-tor01.proxy.cognitiveclass.ai:~$ curl localhost:8080
Copy the URL from the address-bar, to paste in Postman to use GraphQL
```

If the output is as shown in the image above, your service is up and running.

7. Click on the Skills Network button on the left, it will open the "Skills Network Toolbox." Then, click Launch Application, from there you enter port no. 8080 and click Your Application button. This will open a browser window.

8. This will launch a browser page. Copy the URL that you see in the address bar:

```
localhost:8080 -8080.theiadocker-3-labs-prod-theiak8s-4-tor01.proxy.cognitiveclass.ai
```

Copy the URL from the address-bar, to paste in Postman to use GraphQL

Task 3 - Run GraphQL queries on Postman

1. Go to www.postman.com and sign in to Postman. Please note that the home page may look different for every person depending on the day of the year and the region you are signing in from.
2. On the homepage, click **Create new**.

Home Workspaces API Network Explore

Search Postman

Upgrade

Good morning!

Pick up where you left off.

Recently visited workspaces

My Workspace

Get started with Postman

Start with something new

Create a new request, collection, or API in a workspace

[Create New →](#)

Import an existing file

Import any API schema file from your local drive or Github

[Import file →](#)

Announcements

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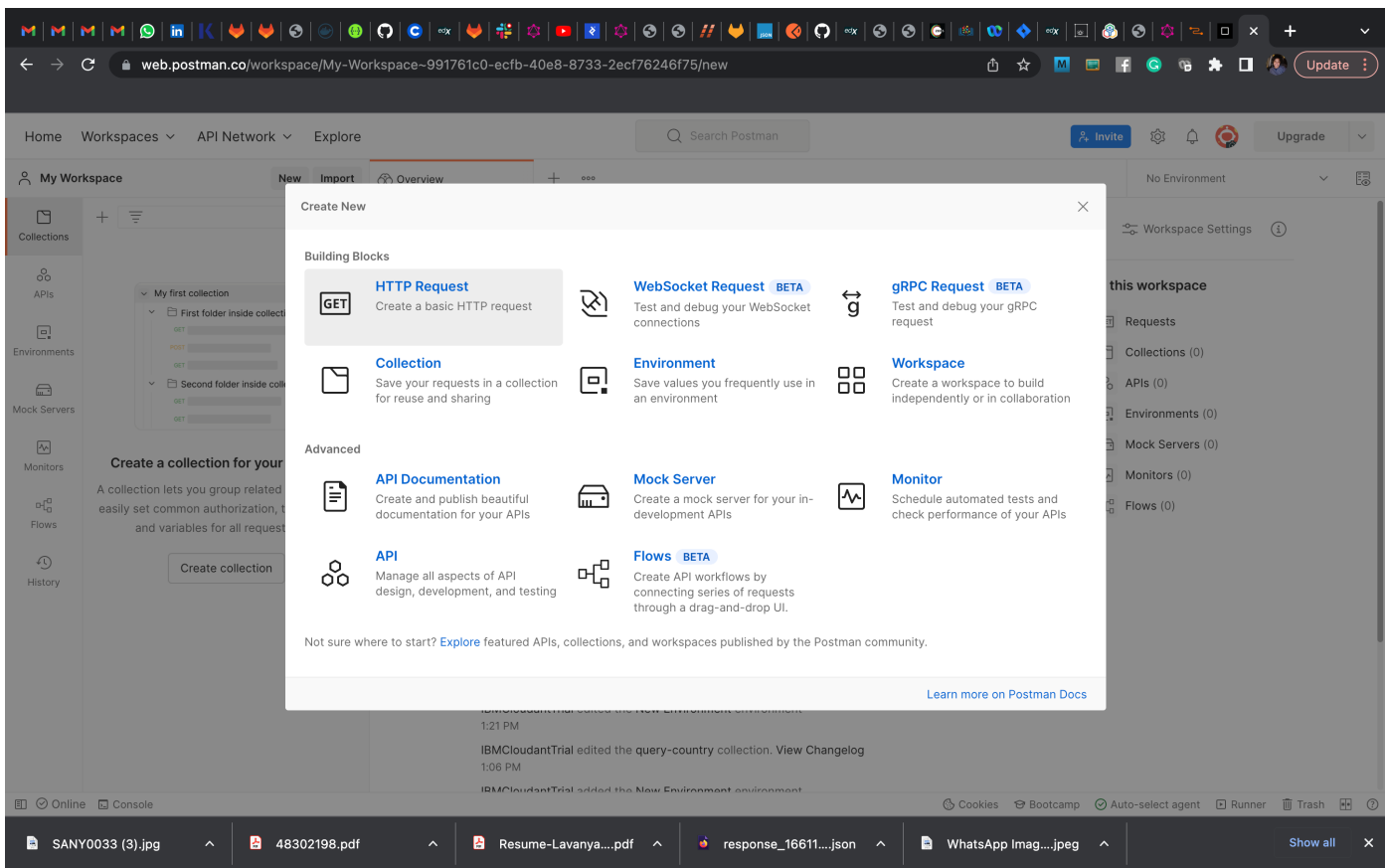
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3. This brings up the set of options you can use with Postman. Choose **HttpRequest**.



4. In the space provided for the GET request URL, paste the URL you copied from step 8 of the previous task and suffix it with `.graphql`.

Overview GET https://lavanyas-8080. No Environment

https://lavanyas-8080.theiadocker-3-labs-prod-theiak8s-4-tor01.proxy.cognitiveclass.ai/graphql

GET https://lavanyas-8080.theiadocker-3-labs-prod-theiak8s-4-tor01.proxy.cognitiveclass.ai/graphql Send

Params Authorization Headers (6) Body Pre-request Script Tests Settings Cookies

Query Params

KEY	VALUE	DESCRIPTION	...	Bulk Edit
Key	Value	Description		

5. Choose **Body** and **GraphQL** as shown in the image below to start entering your query.

https://lavanyas-8080.theiadocker-3-labs-prod-theiak8s-4-tor01.proxy.cognitiveclass.ai/graphql

POST https://lavanyas-8080.theiadocker-3-labs-prod-theiak8s-4-tor01.proxy.cognitiveclass.ai/graphql Send

Params Authorization Headers (8) **Body** Pre-request Script Tests Settings Cookies

☐ none ☐ form-data ☐ x-www-form-urlencoded ☐ raw ☐ binary ☒ GraphQL Auto-fetch C !

QUERY

1

GRAPHQL VARIABLES ⓘ

1

6. You will first query for all the cities in the US. What you can get is the city name and the state they are in. Paste the following in the **Query** tab and click **Send**.

```
{
  cities {
    city
    state
  }
}
```

POSThttps://lavanyas-8080.theiadocker-3-labs-prod-theiak8s-4-tor01.proxy.cognitiveclass.ai/graphqlSend

ParamsAuthorizationHeaders (8)BodyPre-request ScriptTestsSettingsCookies

noneform-datax-www-form-urlencodedrawbinaryGraphQLAuto-fetch

QUERY1 { 2 cities { 3 city 4 state 5 6 }

GRAPHQL VARIABLES1

BodyCookies (1)Headers (7)Test ResultsStatus: 200 OKTime: 885 msSize: 239.93 KBSave Response

PrettyRawPreviewVisualizeJSON

1 { 2 "data": { 3 "cities": [4 { 5 "city": "Abbeville", 6 "state": "Louisiana" 7 }, 8 { 9 "city": "Aberdeen", 10 "state": "Maryland" 11 }, 12] 13 } 14 }

As you can see, it lists all the 5980 cities in the US in the output tab.

7. You can now try to retrieve just the names of the cities in a particular state. To do this, you need to pass the state as a parameter. You will now request the state name in the return value as you are querying only for one state.

```
{  "cities(state:"Florida") {  "city"  } }
```

GEThttps://lavanyas-8080.theiadocker-3-labs-prod-theiak8s-4-tor01.proxy.cognitiveclass.ai/graphql

ParamsAuthorizationHeaders (8)BodyScriptsTestsSettingsCookies

noneform-datax-www-form-urlencodedrawbinaryGraphQLAuto-fetch

QUERY1 { 2 cities(state:"Florida") { 3 city 4 } 5 }

GRAPHQL VARIABLES1

BodyCookies (1)Headers (7)Test ResultsStatus: 200 OKTime: 885 msSize: 239.93 KBSave Response

PrettyRawPreviewVisualizeJSON

1 { 2 "data": { 3 "cities": [4 { 5 "city": "Alachua" 6 }, 7 { 8 "city": "Altamonte Springs" 9 }, 10 { 11 "city": "Andover" 12 } 13] 14 } 15 }

As you can see, only the names of the cities in Florida are returned.

Additional Task

- 1. Construct a query to return all the cities in the state of "Ohio," along with the state name.
- [Click here for the solution](#)
- Congratulations! You have learned to construct queries using GraphQL.
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